



FOSS FESTIVAL

Hackers for Hackers

The GNU/Linux Software Development Workshop of GLUG-Meerut became an icebreaker.

*F*OSS FESTIVAL 2009 (9th-11th January 2009) at IIMT Engineering College, Meerut was like a breath of fresh air within the FOSS world of UP. Jointly organised by 'GNU/Linux User Group-Meerut' and IIMT Engineering College, the workshop focused on grooming budding hackers from all over India. It was one among a few 'FOSS-only' development workshops in north India.

As the GLUG-Meerut coordinator Mohit Singh said, 'FOSS FESTIVAL 2009 is the first step of its kind in the journey of the software freedom movement in UP and the associated regions. As it follows the guideline, 'of the hacker, for the hacker and by the hacker', we firmly believe that it will create a big bang for FOSS in the region and beyond.'

Being the first national FOSS event of the

year, FOSS FESTIVAL 2009 attracted the entire Indian FOSS community by involving hackers of national recognition as well as covering rarely touched topics of wide importance in academics, industry and research. The motive was to act as a catalyst and an appetiser for young minds as well as to attract fresh talent from the large number of engineering colleges in Meerut and beyond.

The workshop had two parallel hands-on tracks from the LAMP stack (called FOSS FESTIVAL LAMPsticks): 'Open Source Web Development' and 'GNU/Linux System Programming'. The first track focused on Apache, MySQL, PHP and Open Source Projects like 'Sahana', while the second track covered GNU/Linux BASHing, GNU ToolChain, POSIX API, GTK+ Toolkit and Linux Device Driver Development.